

Tejaswin Shankar

Tejaswin Shankar has advanced considerably since his Hangzhou decathlon silver of 7,666 points. He won February's Asian Indoor heptathlon with an Indian record of 5,993, then became the first Indian past 8,000 points in the decathlon, scoring 8,057 at the Federation Cup. At the Commonwealth Games, he managed patellar-tendon pain and still collected bronze with 7,976. He is not the favourite in Japan. Home entrant Yuma Maruyama scored a Japanese record 8,321 at April's Mt SAC Relays and comfortably owns the strongest mark in the expected Asian field. Japan has also selected Keisuke Okuda, the 2025 Asian bronze medallist, while China's published team names include Chen Xinghua. Shankar's high jump and long jump can build an early cushion, but pole vault and javelin remain swing events. If his knee holds and he stays close to Maruyama through nine disciplines, his superior 1500m endurance can keep gold alive until the final straight.

MEN'S
DECATHLON

